Data on the Labor Force in Dominican Republic

Justin Lesniak

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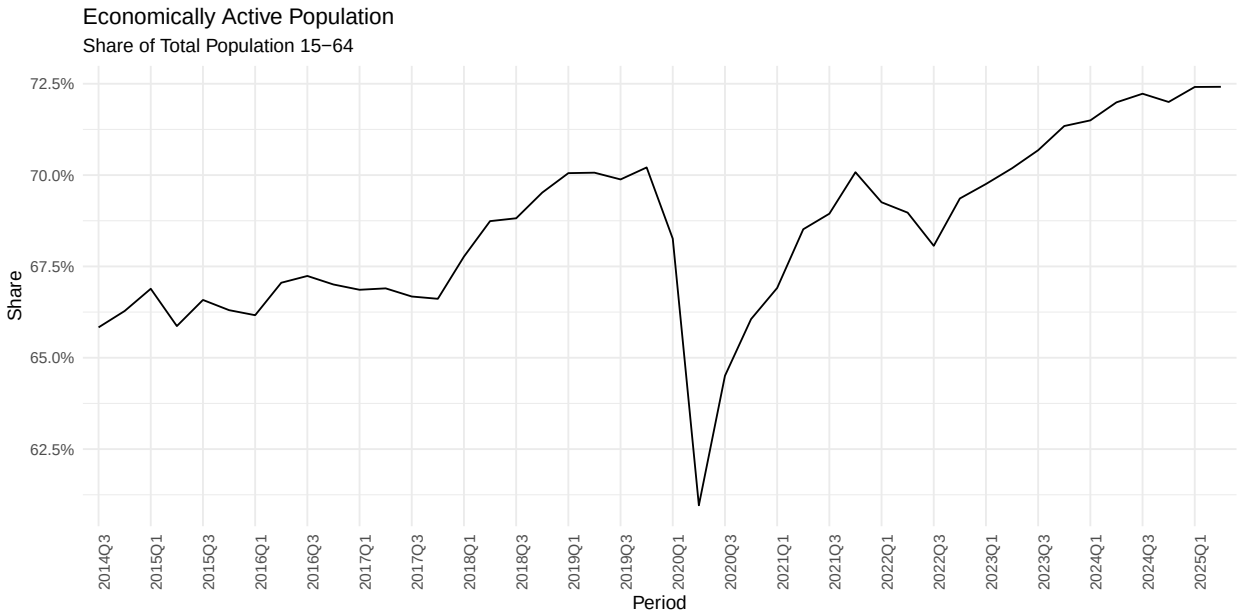
General Trends in the Labor Market

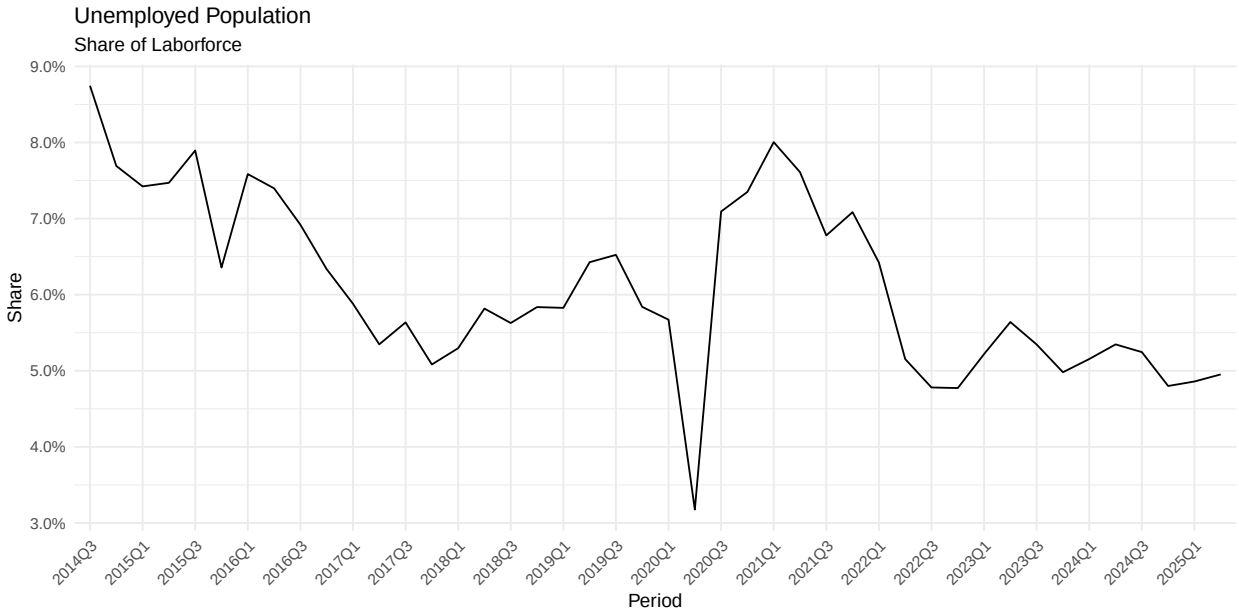
Overall, we can see at a macro level labor force participation had been trending up pre-Covid, experienced a drop and seems to have recovered.

Leading up to Covid there was a slight rise in formal work and a decline in informality, after Covid this seems to have reversed. Clear majorities of the workforce are either self-employed or employed in the private sector and this is fairly stable over time. Largest sectors of employment are commerce and the rest of the service sector.

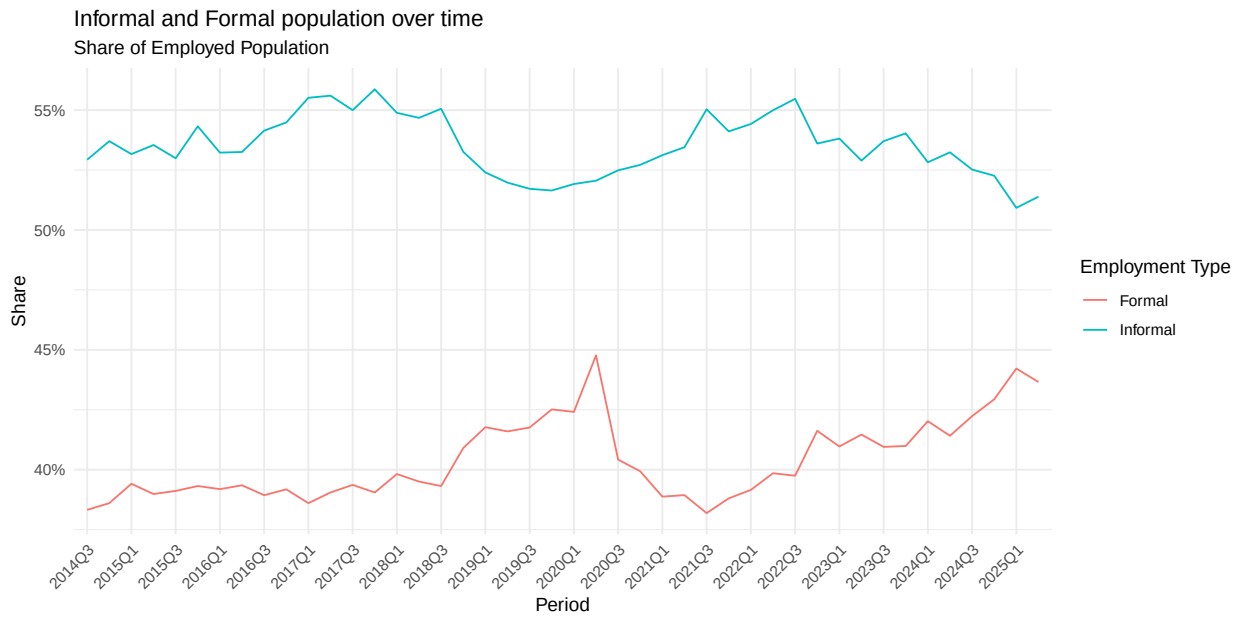
There has been a slight increase in the share of the labor force that is female. Education levels have been increasing over time with more people completing secondary education but not necessarily university level education.

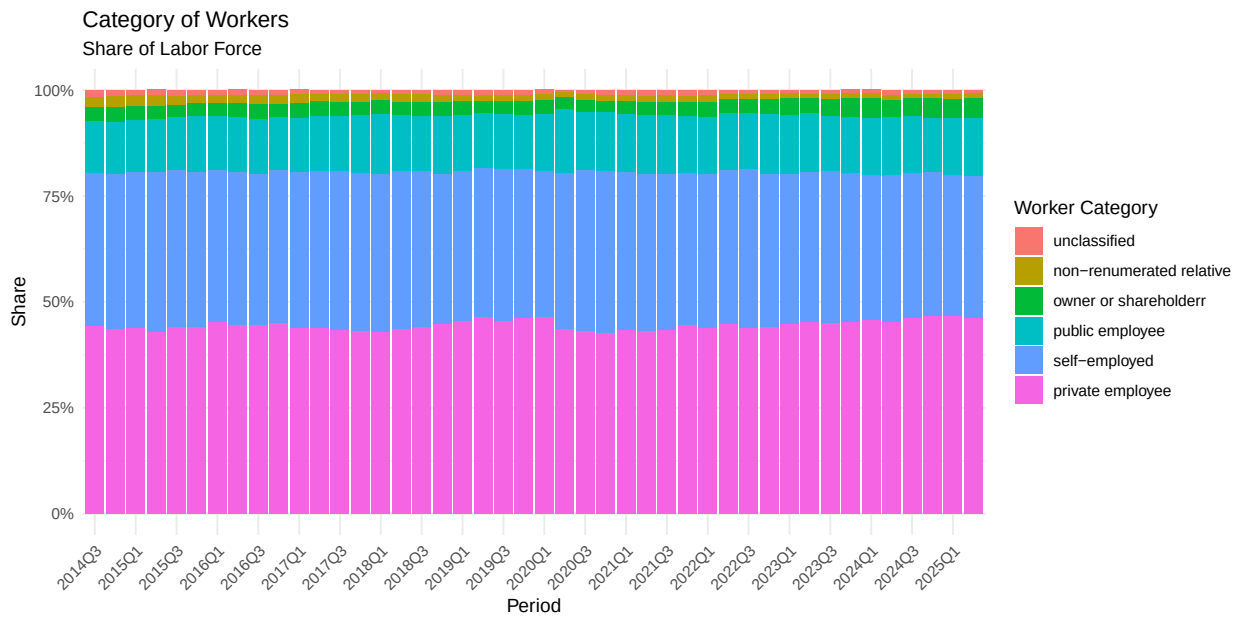
Macro Trends

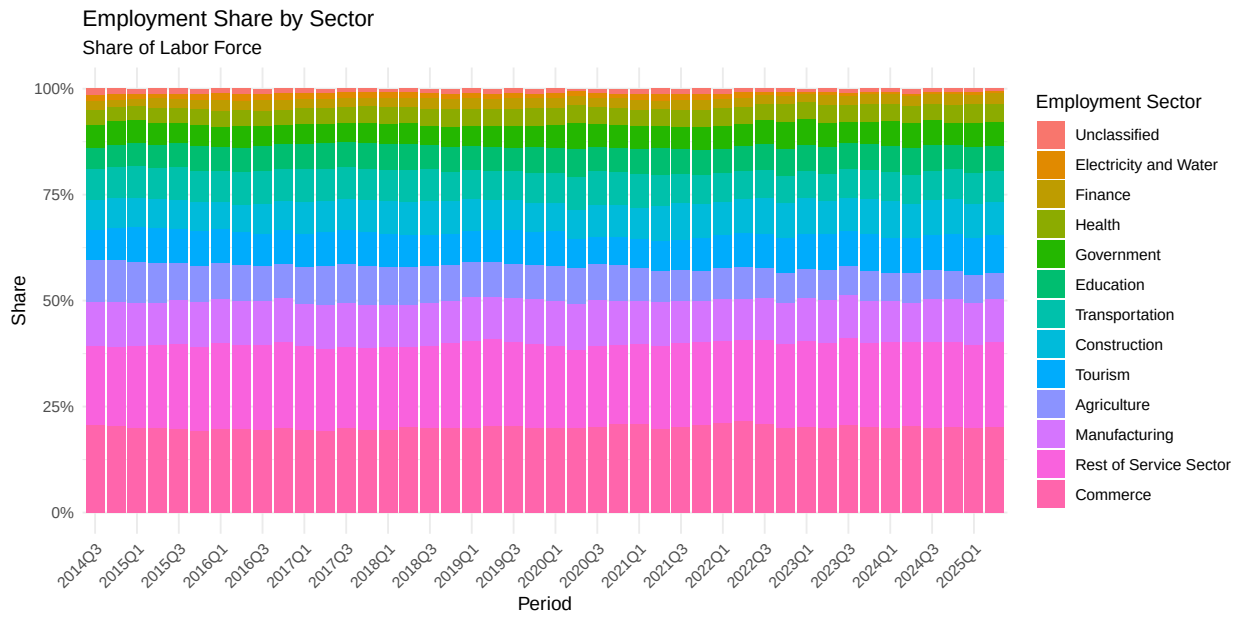




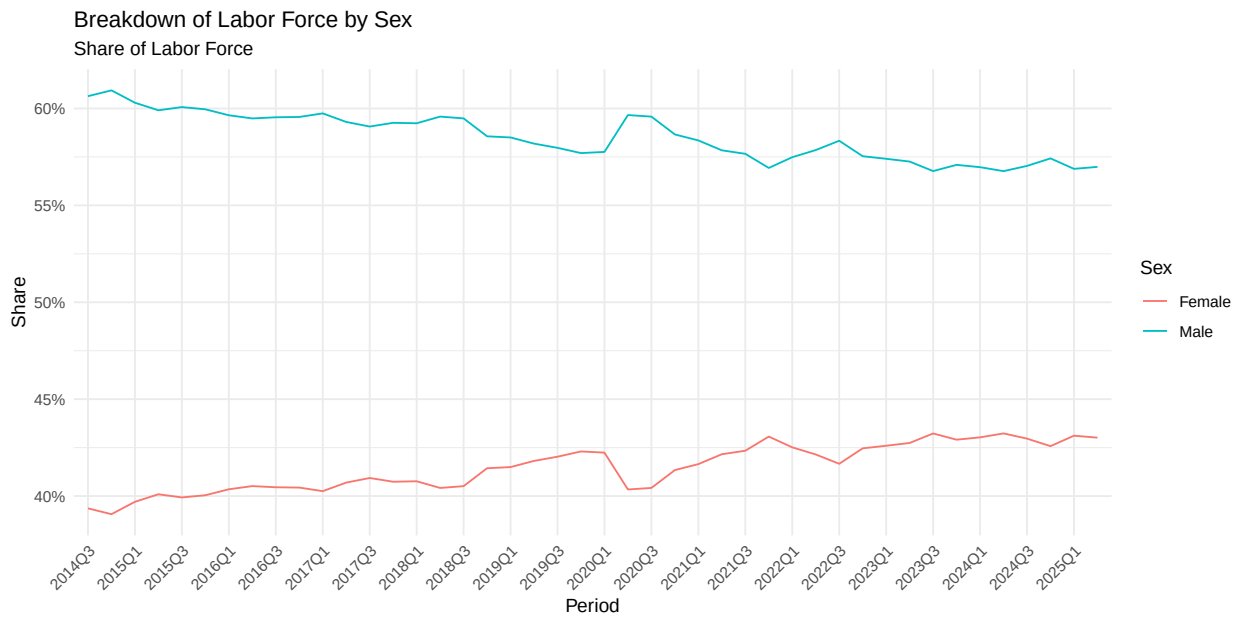
Trends in Employment Type

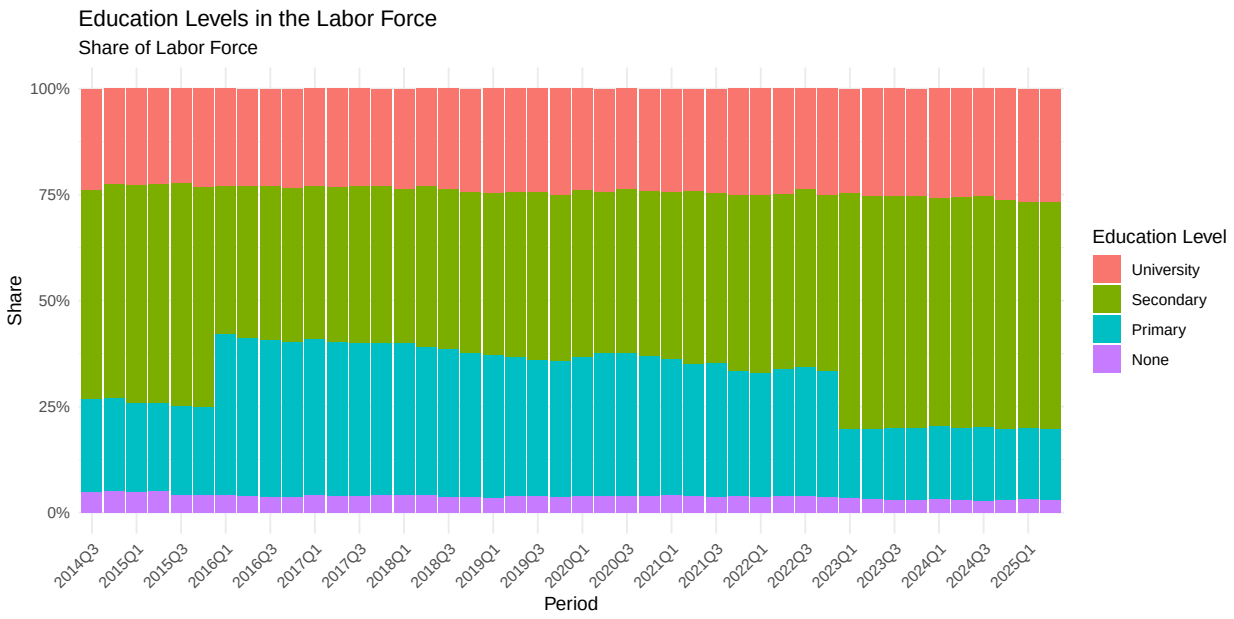


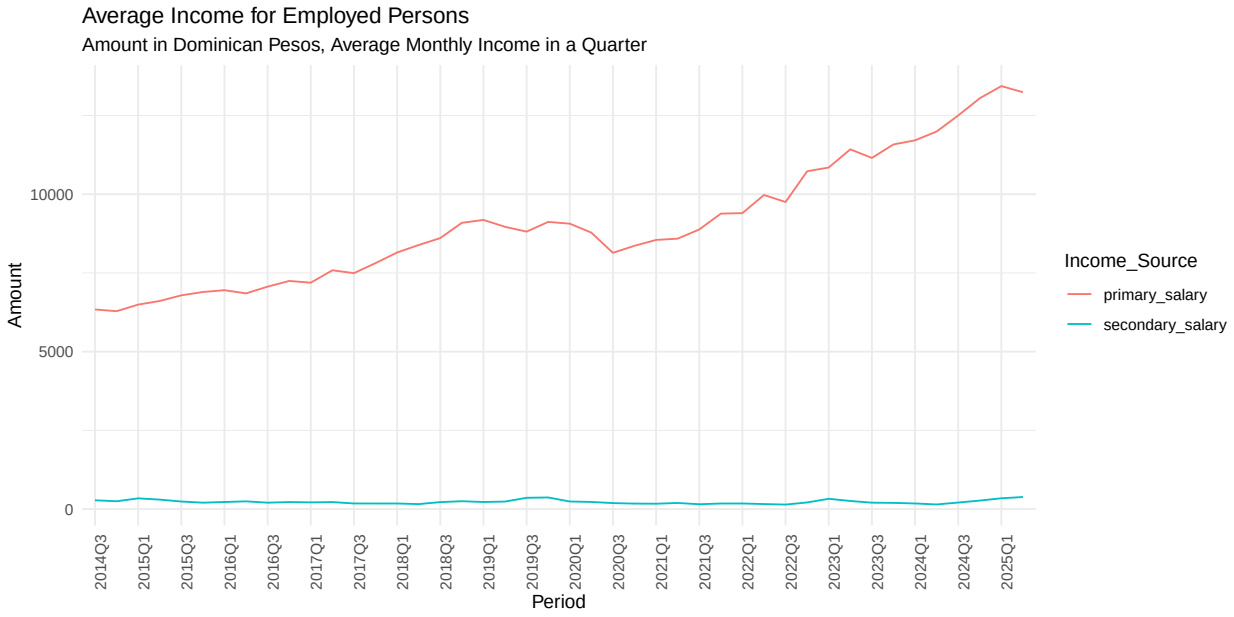


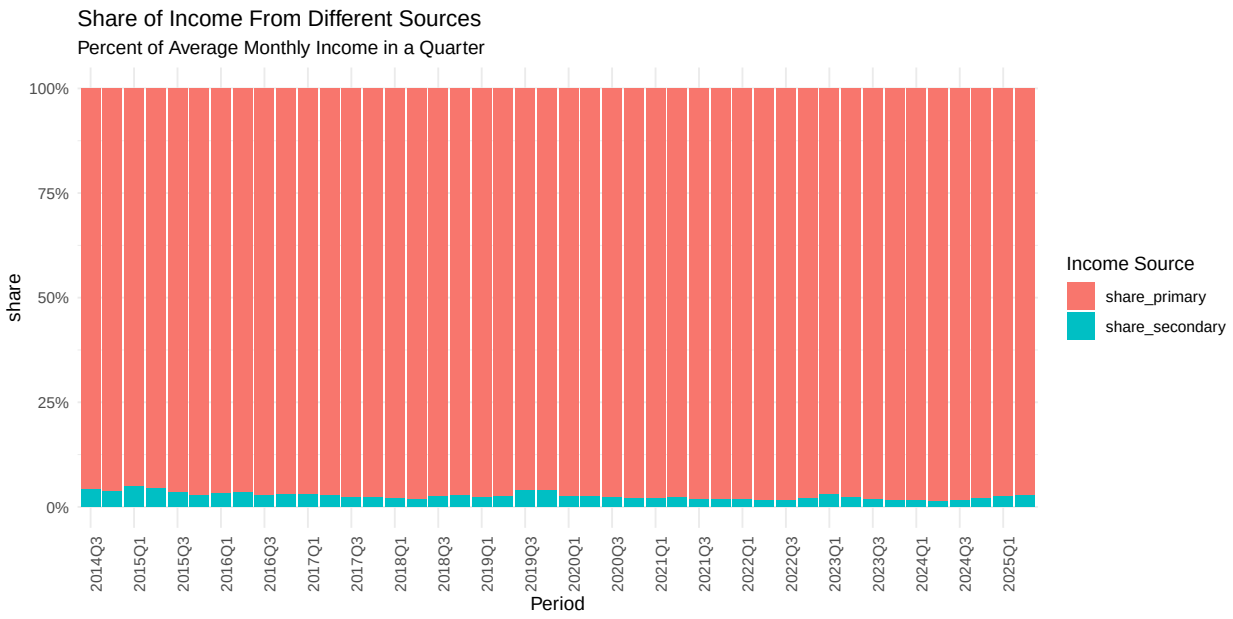


Trends in Worker Characteristics




Education Levels in the Labor Force
Share of Labor Force
100%
75%
50%
25%
0%
Share
2014Q3
2015Q1
2015Q3
2016Q1
2016Q3
2017Q1
2017Q3
2018Q1
2018Q3
2019Q1
2019Q3
2020Q1
2020Q3
2021Q1
2021Q3
2022Q1
2022Q3
2023Q1
2023Q3
2024Q1
2024Q3
2025Q1
Period
Education Level
University
Secondary
Primary
None


Average Income for Employed Persons
Amount in Dominican Pesos, Average Monthly Income in a Quarter
10000
5000
0
Amount
2014Q3
2015Q1
2015Q3
2016Q1
2016Q3
2017Q1
2017Q3
2018Q1
2018Q3
2019Q1
2019Q3
2020Q1
2020Q3
2021Q1
2021Q3
2022Q1
2022Q3
2023Q1
2023Q3
2024Q1
2024Q3
2025Q1
Period
Income_Source
primary_salary
secondary_salary

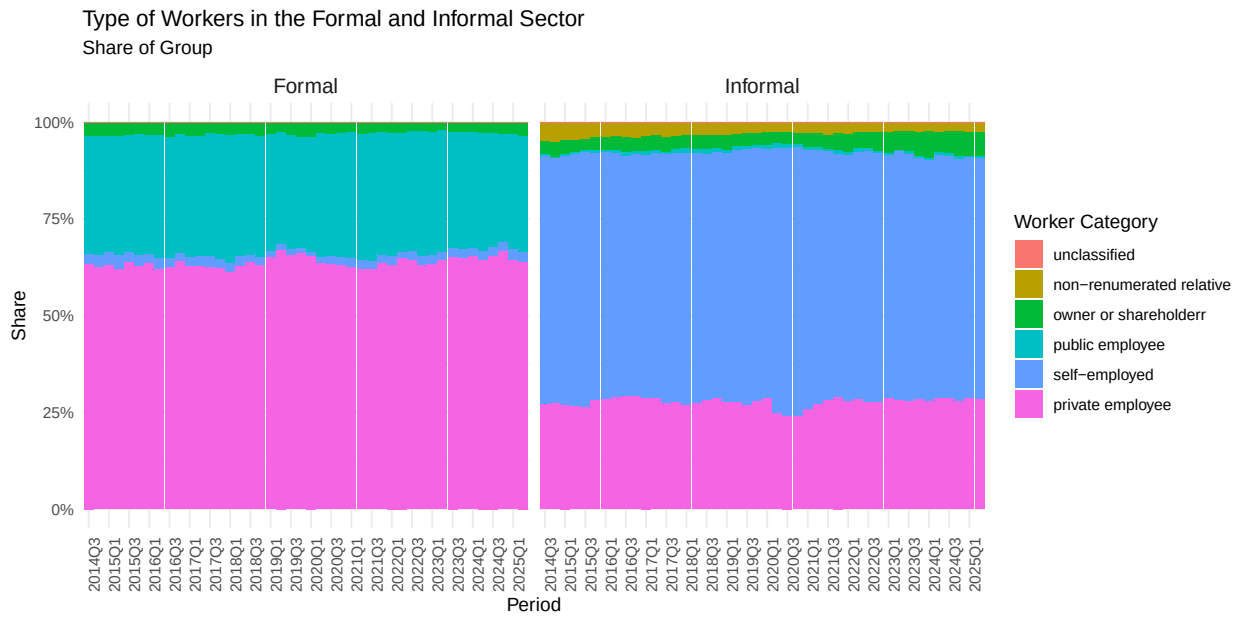


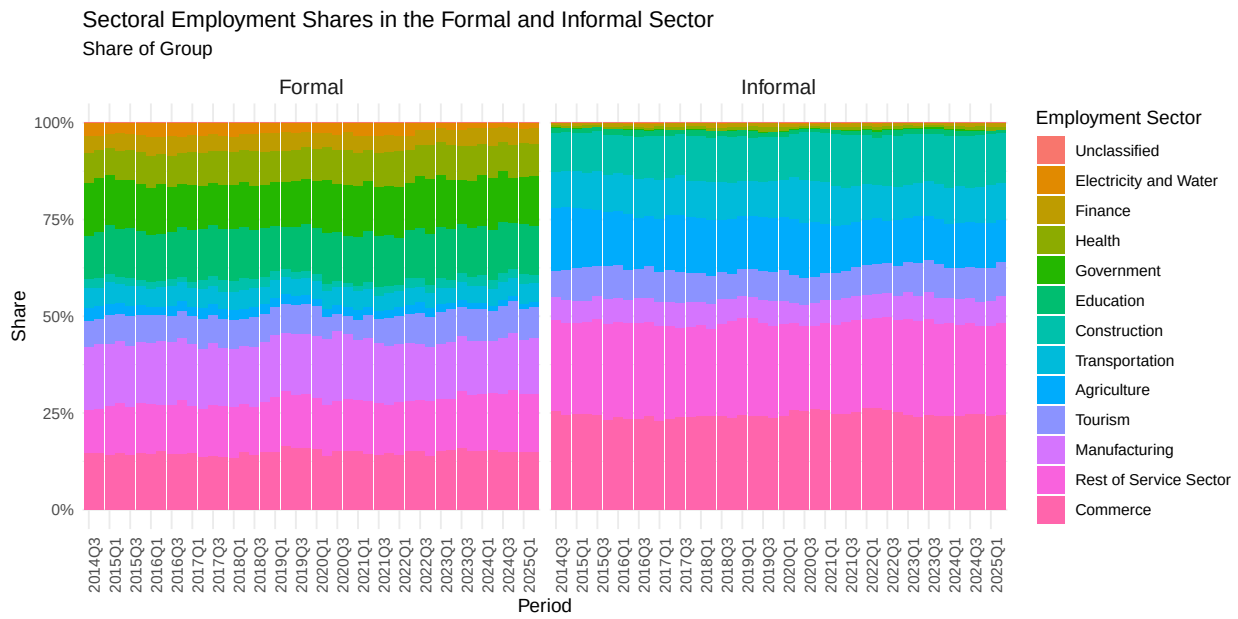
Trends in Formal vs Informal Sector Workers

Comparing formal and informal sector we can see most workers with formal employment are classified as either private or public sector employees. In the informal sector there is are a significant number of private sector employees but the largest group is self-employed which makes up a negligible amount of formal employment. Looking at economic sectors, we see commerce and rest of services is a bit more dominant in the informal sector while the formal sector has a more even mix of sectors.

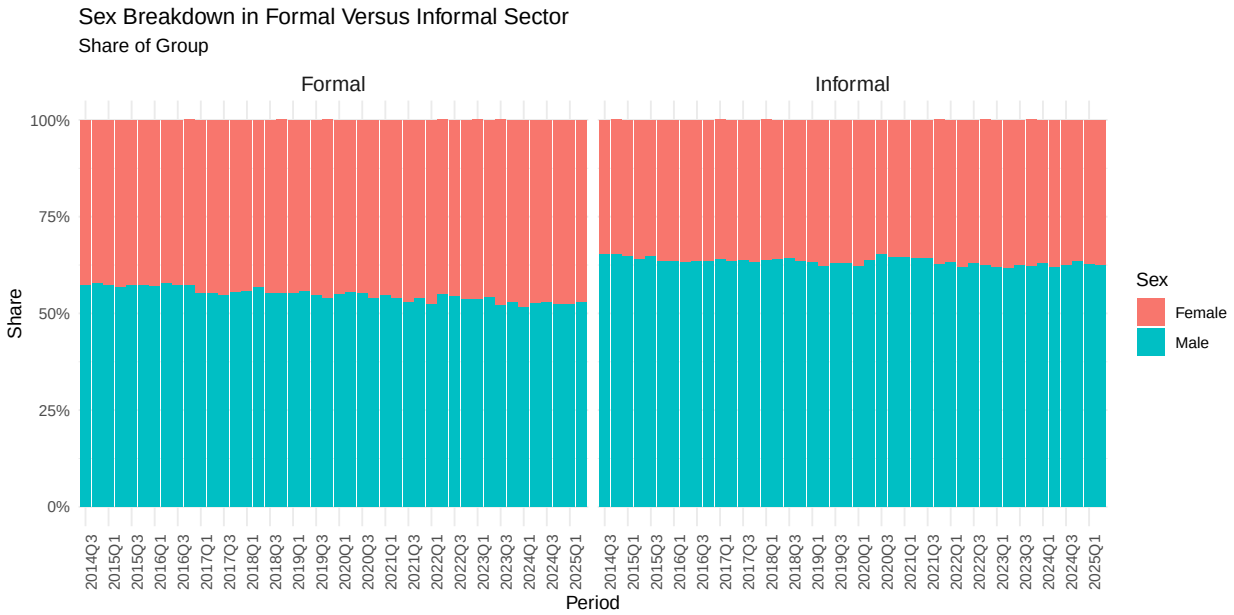
According to the survey men make up the majority of both types of workers but have even greater representation in the informal sector. Looking at education levels, the formal sector workers have secondary or higher education for the most part while in the informal sector the majority have primary education although this share is falling and being replaced by workers with secondary education over time.

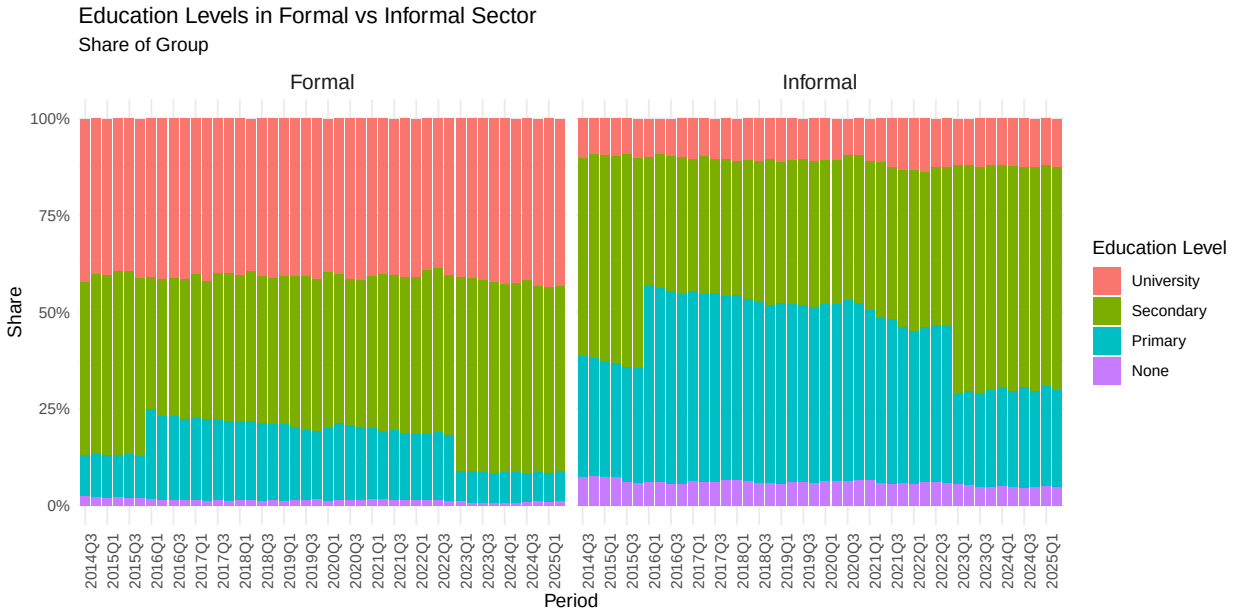
Trends in Employment Type Within the Formal vs Informal Sector

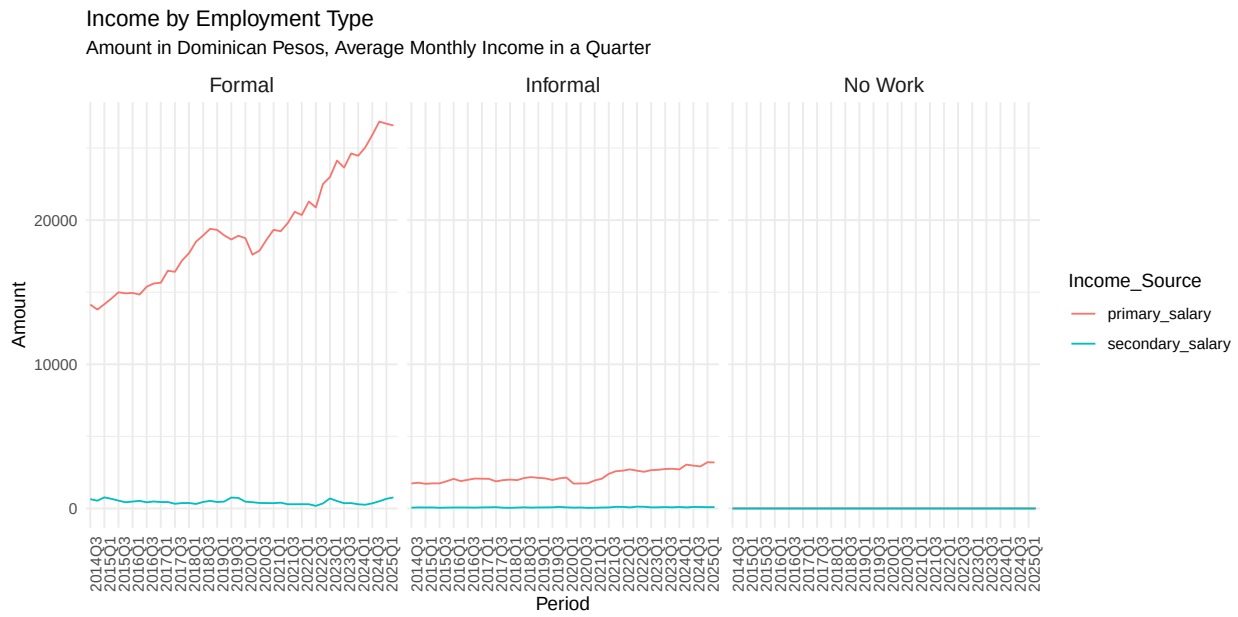




Trends in Worker Traits and Outcomes Within the Formal vs Informal Sector





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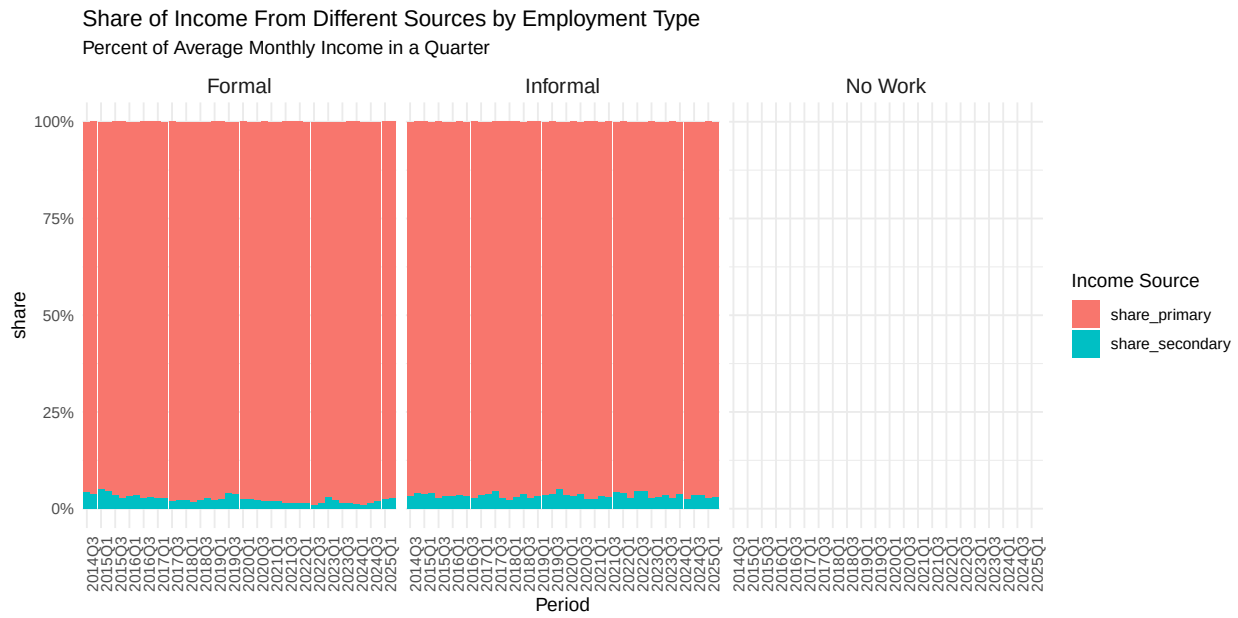


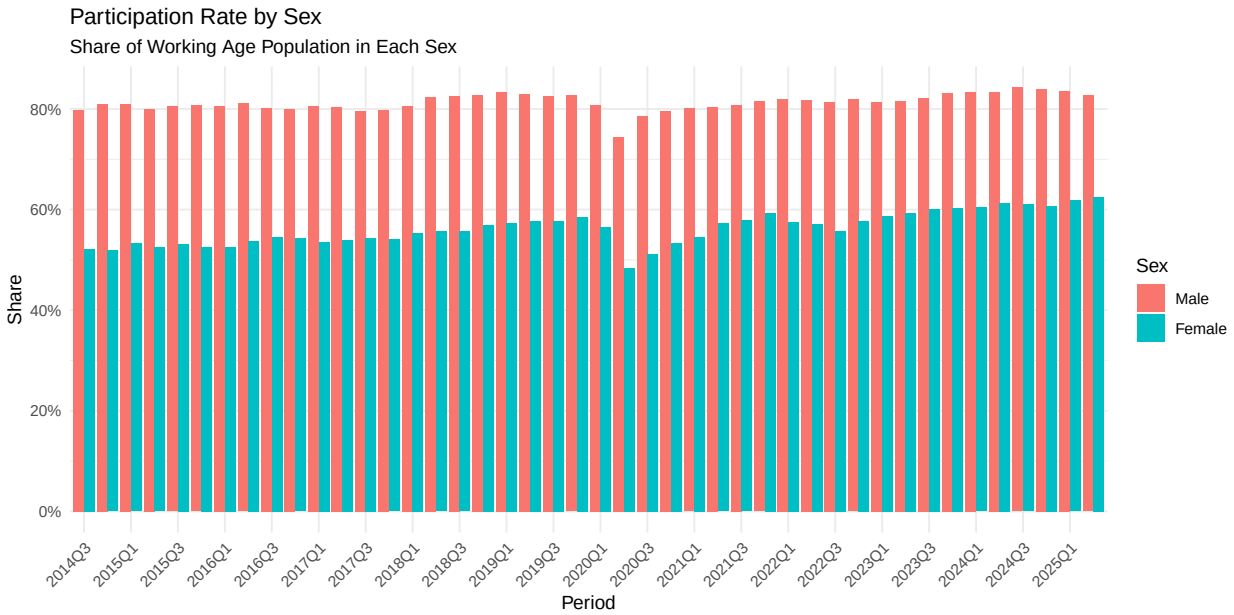
Labor Force Trends by Sex

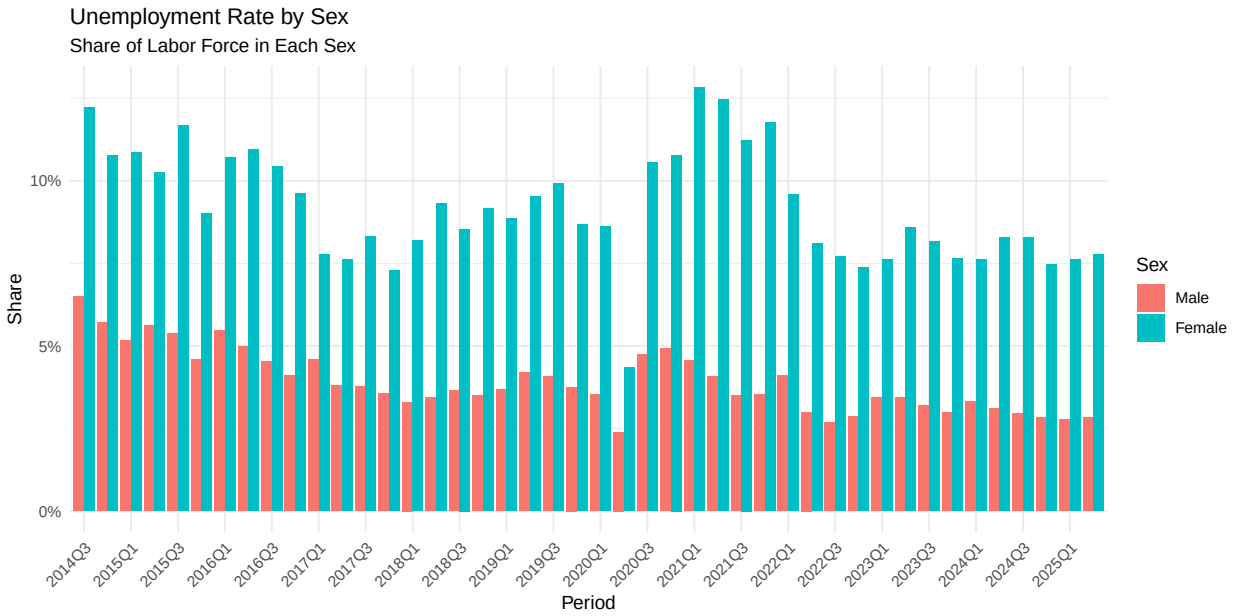
Looking at the labor force in terms of sex we see that men seem to be more successful than women. The male participation rate is about 15% higher than the female participation rate and the unemployment rate is almost half for men compared to women in most years.

In terms of type of employment, we can see men have slightly more informal work and less formal work compared to women. We can also see that men have a higher share of people self-employed while women have more employment that is unclassified in the survey. Looking at the sector data, the service sectors are a bit more dominate for women than men.

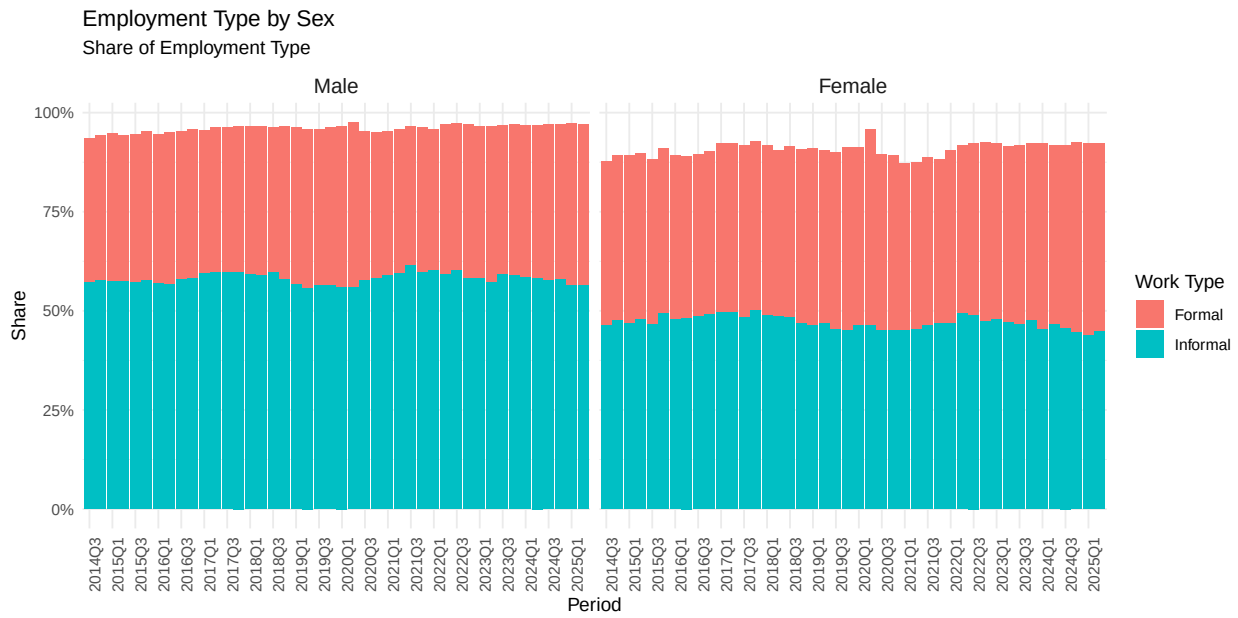
A higher share of women than men have university education and yet their salary is significantly lower than men on average. There seems to be a similar trend in salary increases for both groups.

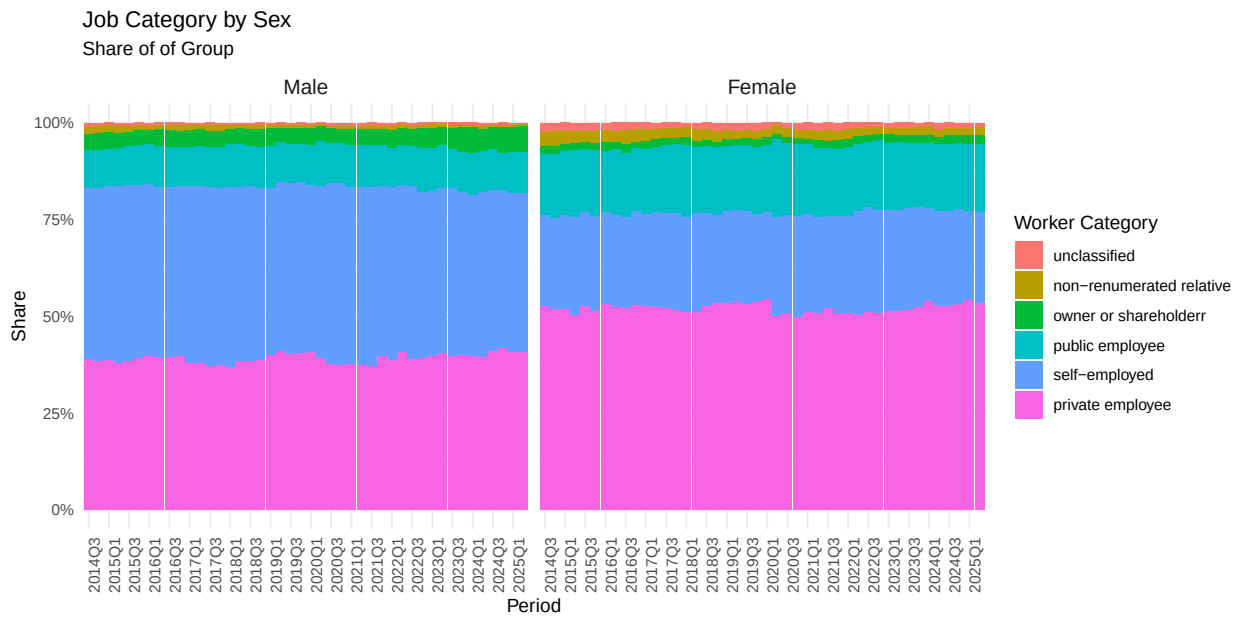
Macro Trends in the Labor Market by Sex

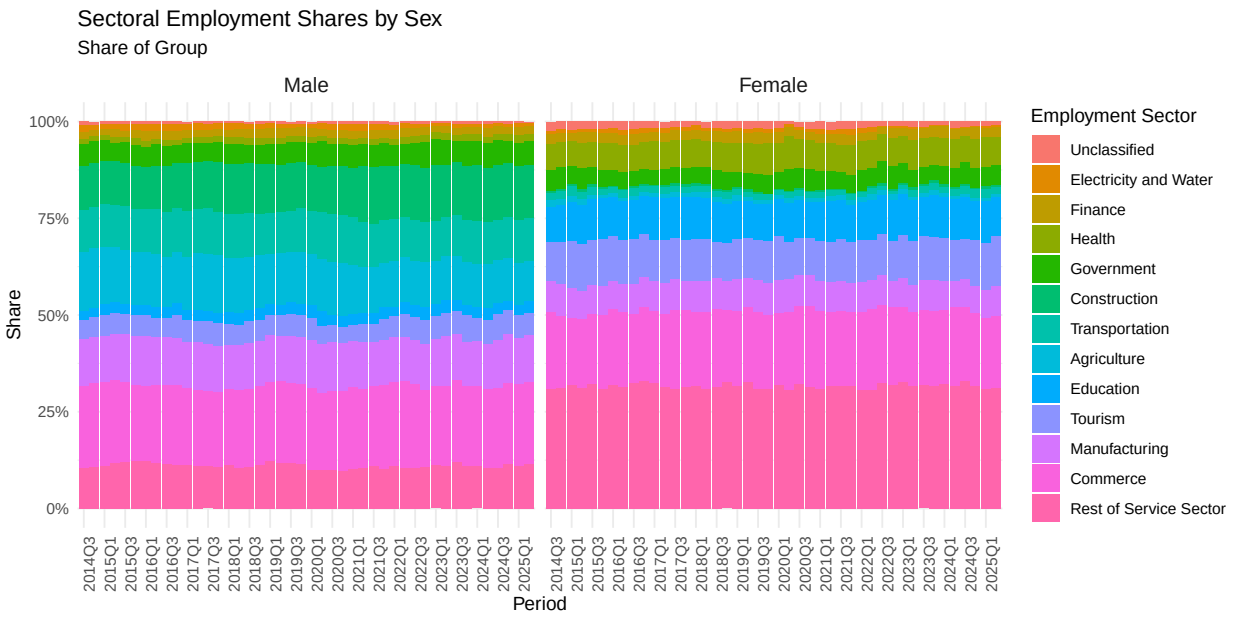




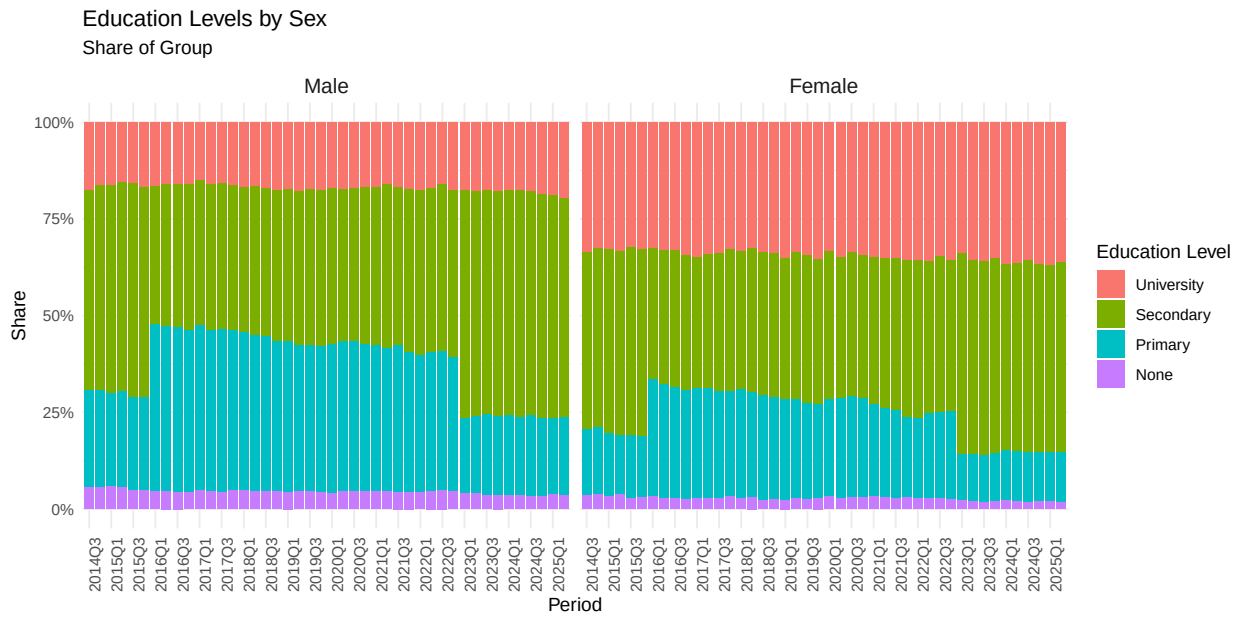
Trends in Employment type by Sex

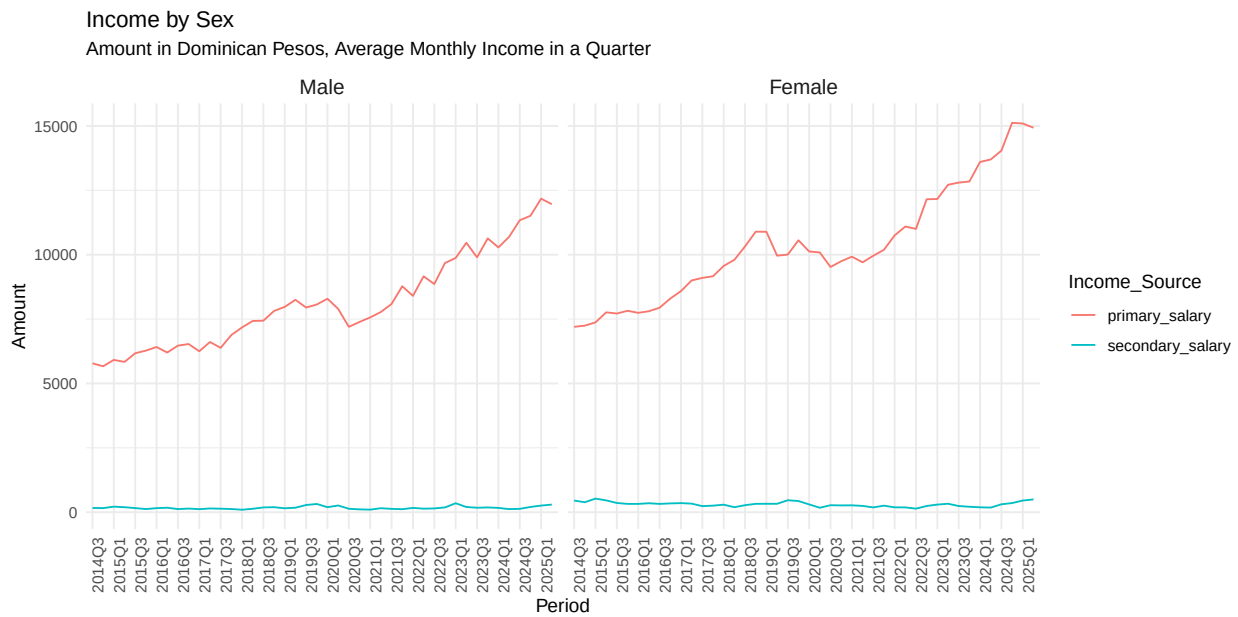


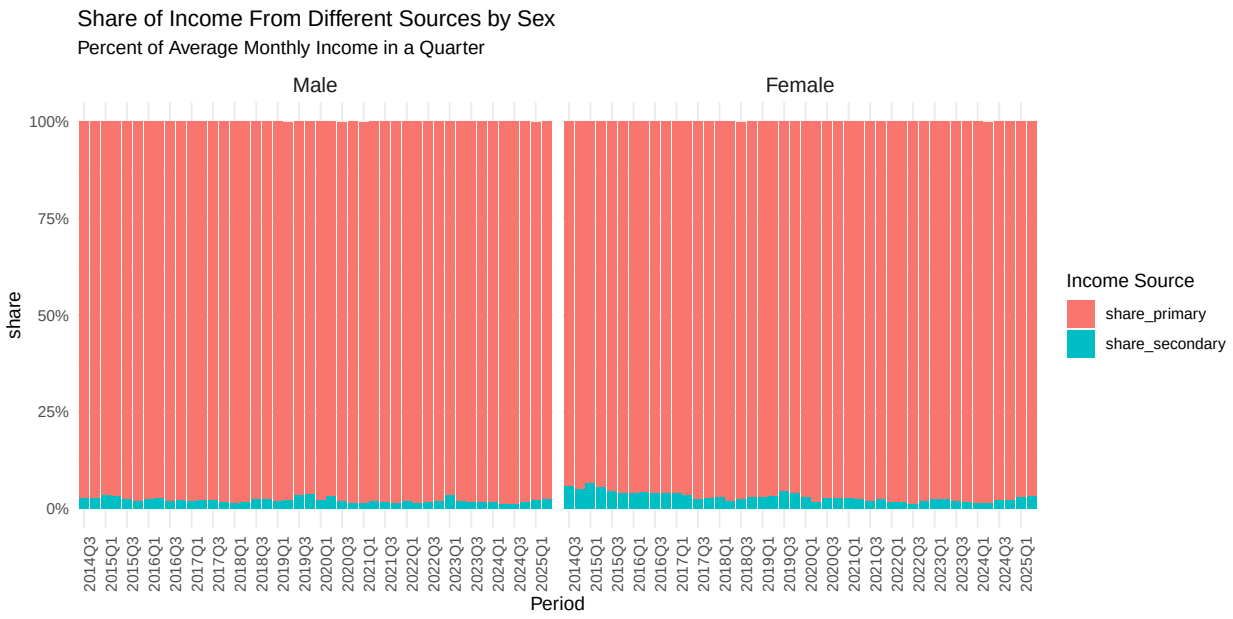



Sectoral Employment Shares by Sex
Share of Group
Male
Female
Share
100%
75%
50%
25%
0%
Period
Employment Sector
Unclassified
Electricity and Water
Finance
Health
Government
Construction
Transportation
Agriculture
Education
Tourism
Manufacturing
Commerce
Rest of Service Sector

Trends in Worker Traits and Outcomes by Sex







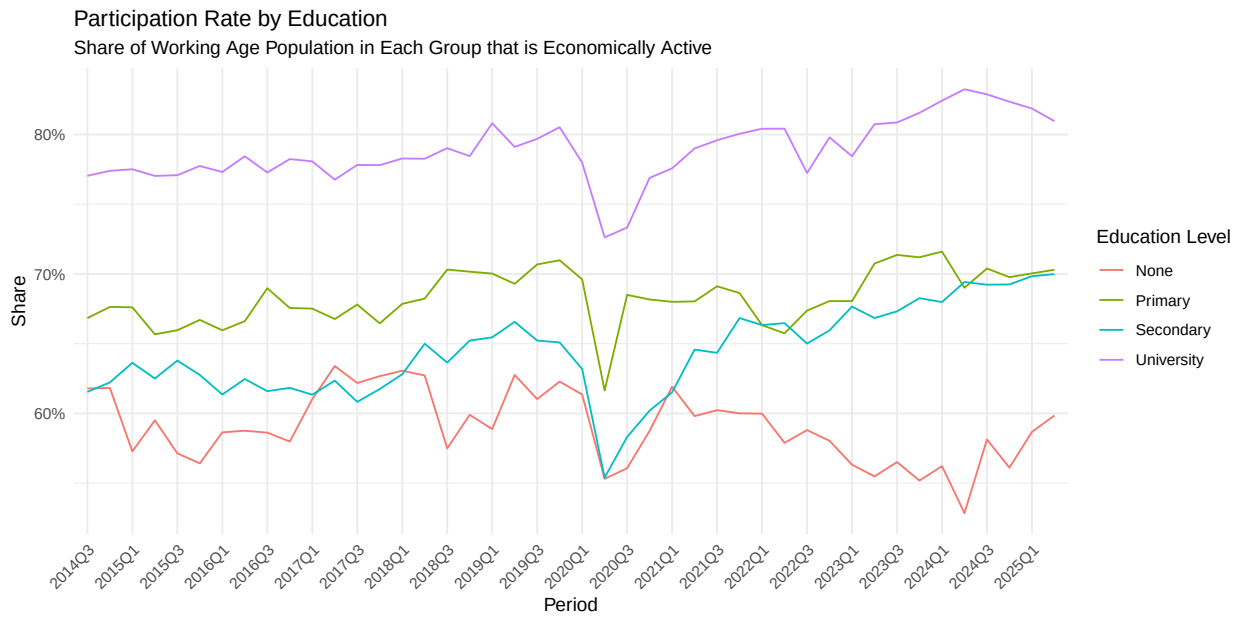
Labor Force Trends by Education Level

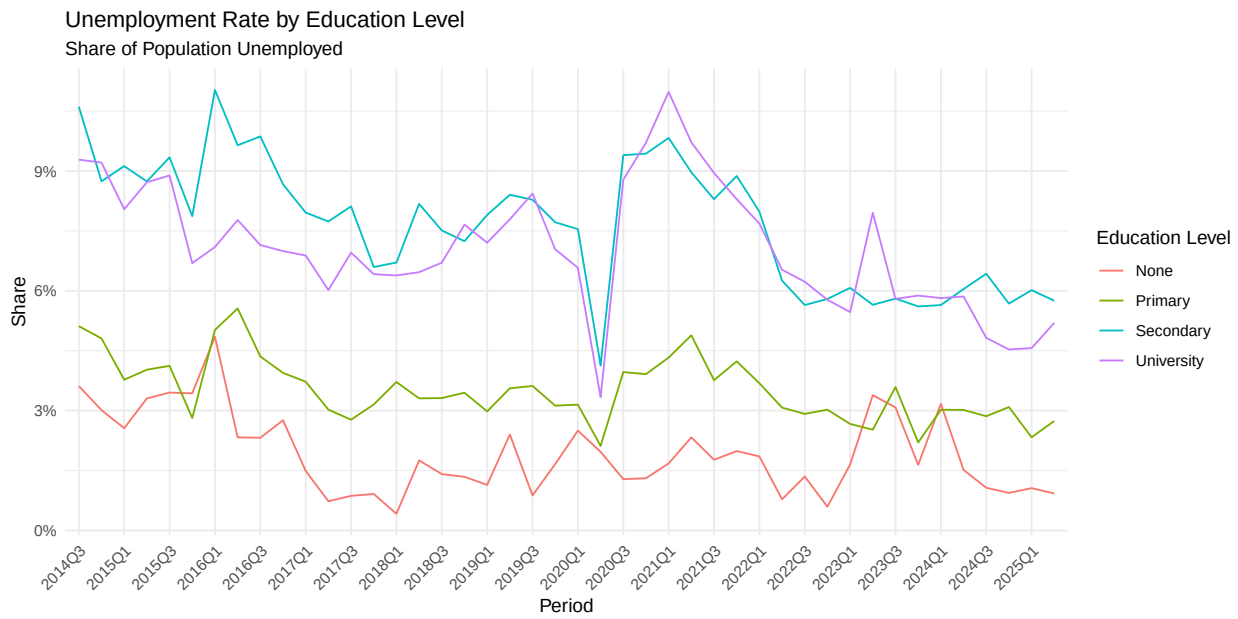
Looking at the labor force in terms of education it appears participation rates go up substantially with education as do unemployment rates.

More educated groups have a higher proportion of members working in the formal sector as opposed to the informal sector. In terms of job category, we see that the share of people working in "unclassified" jobs according to the survey drops substantially with education level. We also see that there is a greater diversity of sectoral work in the higher education groups.

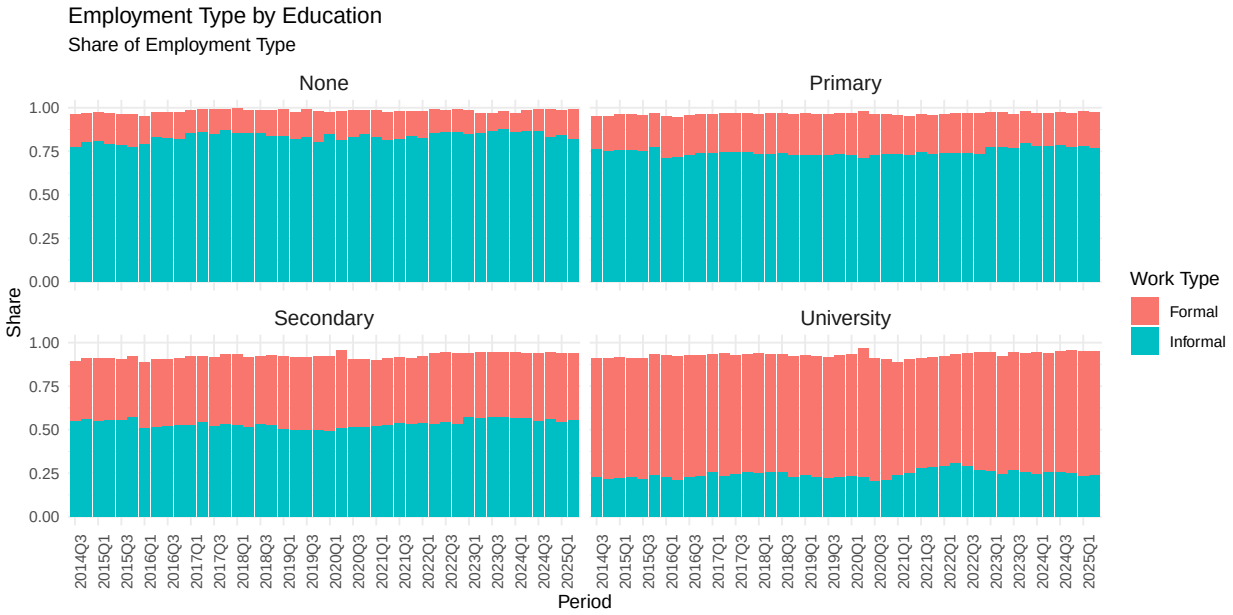
In terms of income there appears to be a significant premium for secondary school graduates and an even greater increase for university graduates relative to those with only primary education.

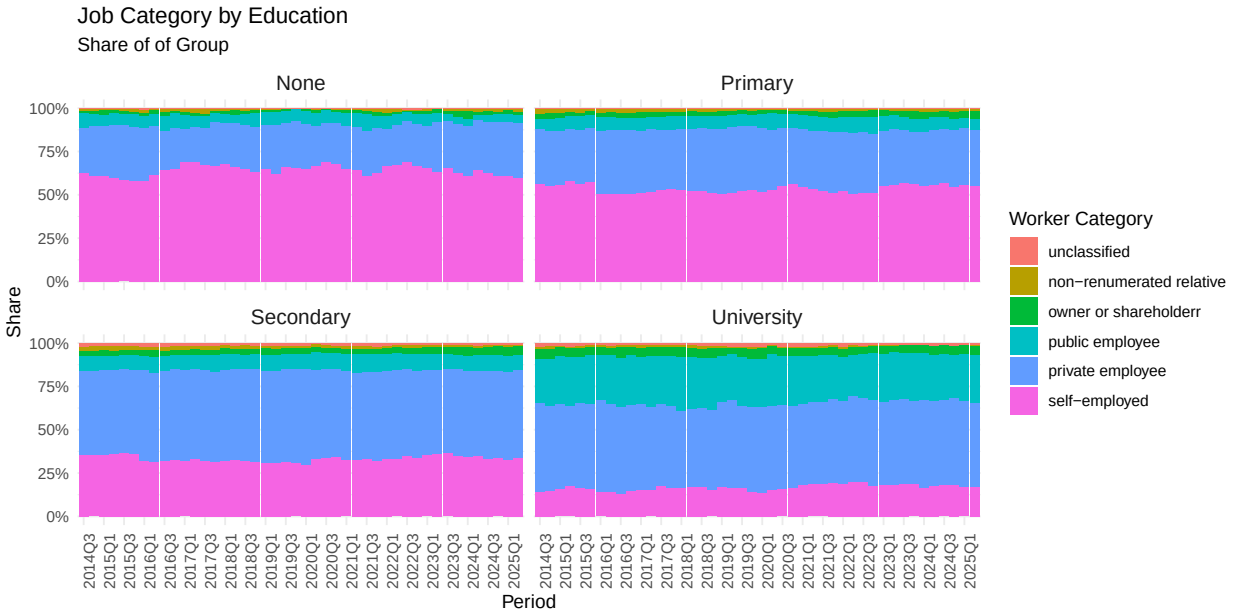
Macro Trends in the Labor Force by Education Level

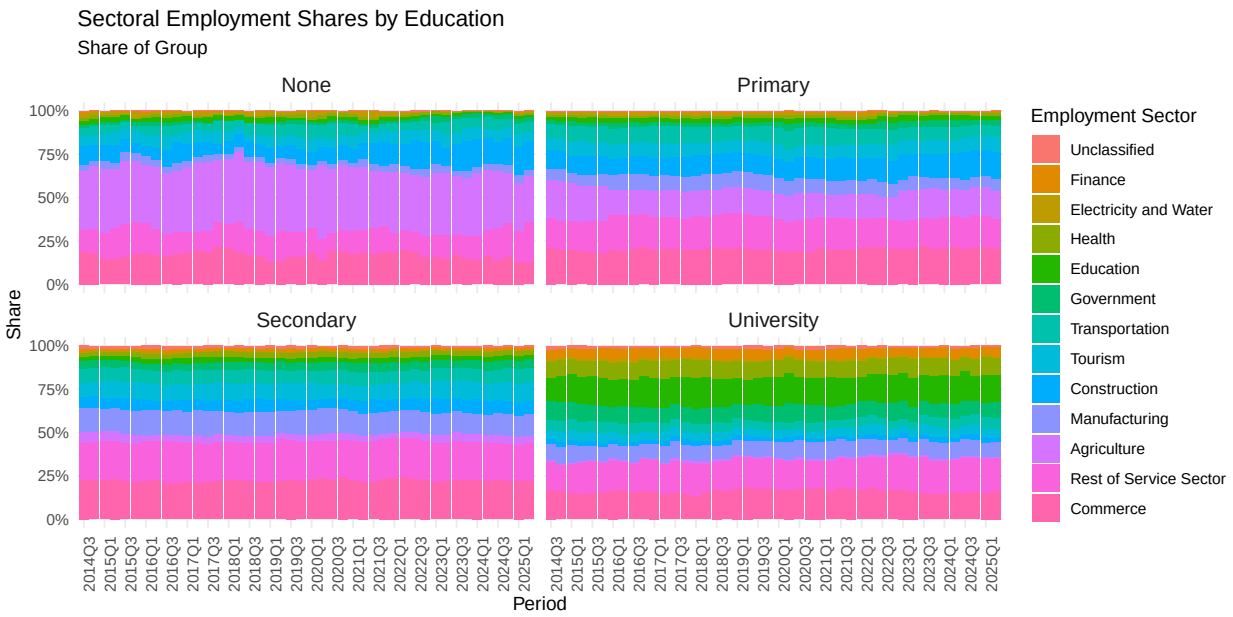
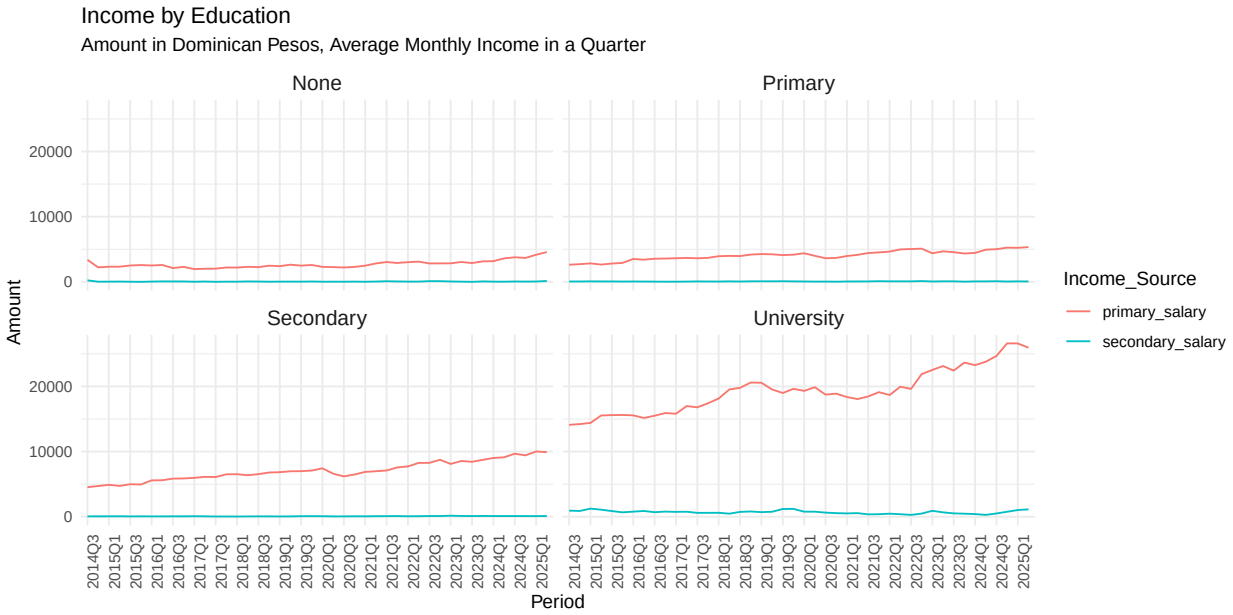
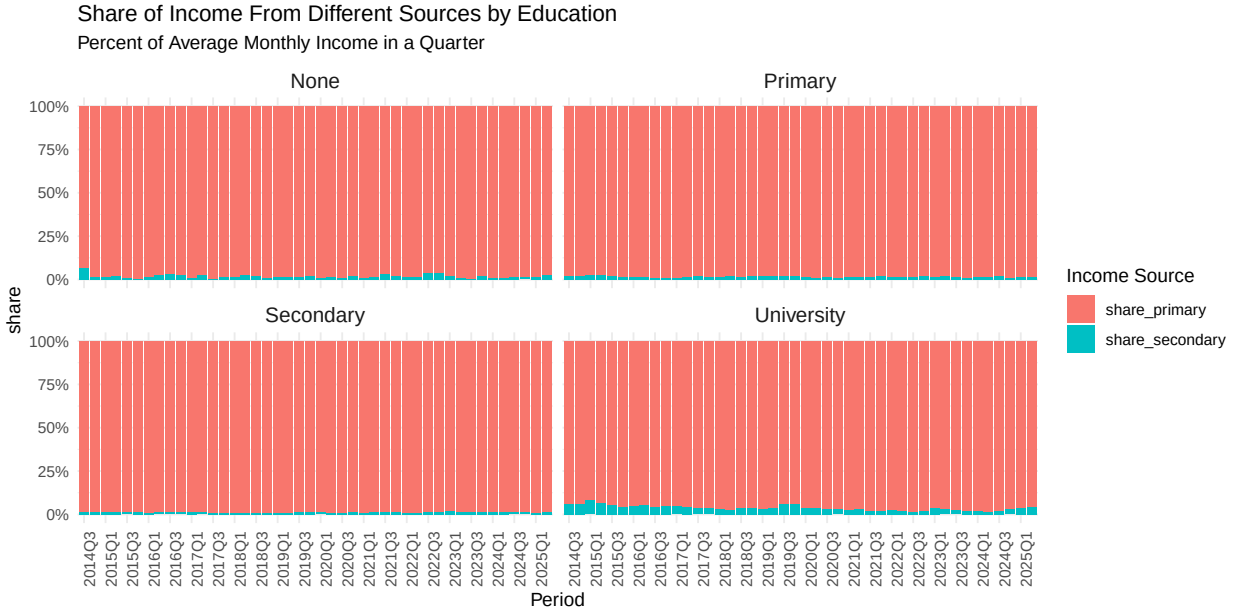




Trends in Employment type by Education Level






Sectoral Employment Shares by Education
Share of Group
None
Primary
Secondary
University
Share
100%
75%
50%
25%
0%
Period
Employment Sector
Unclassified
Finance
Electricity and Water
Health
Education
Government
Transportation
Tourism
Construction
Manufacturing
Agriculture
Rest of Service Sector
Commerce

Trends in Worker Traits and Outcomes by Education Level